Examples Oviparous - *Ornithorhynchus* (Platypus), Viviparous - *Macropus* (Kangaroo), *Pteropus* (Flying fox), *Macaca* (Monkey), *Canis* (Dog), *Felis* (Cat), *Elephas* (Elephant), *Equus* (Horse), *Delphinus* (Common dolphin) *Balaenoptera* (Blue whale), *Panthera tigris* (Tiger), *Panther leo* (Lion), *Homo sapiens* (Human) *Bos* (Cattle) (Figure 2.28).

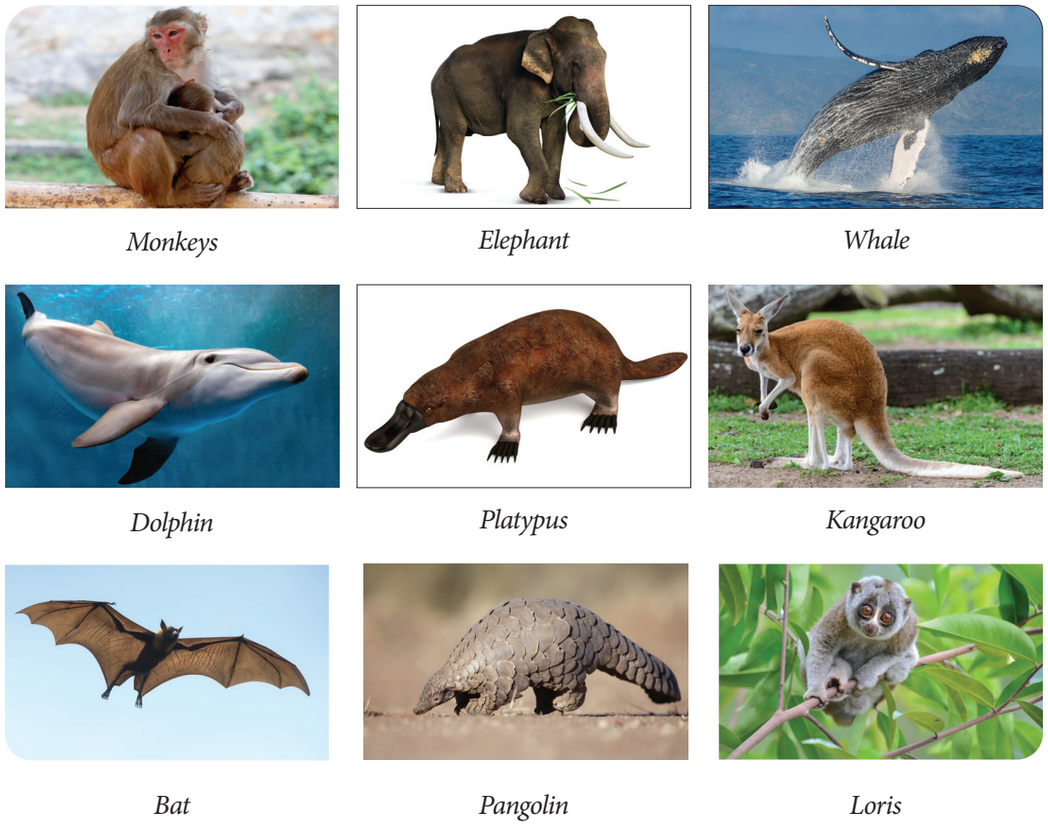


Figure 2.28 Examples of Mammals

Summary

Kingdom Animalia comprises of a broad range of animal species, from tiny parasitic nematodes to the largest mammal the blue whale. The basic fundamental features such as levels of organisation, diploblastic and triploblastic organisation, patterns of symmetry, coelom, segmentation and notochord have enabled us to broadly classify the animal kingdom. Besides the fundamental features, there are many other distinctive characters which are specific for each phyla or class.

Animals are broadly classified into invertebrates and chordates. The animals which lack vertebral column are called invertebrates. The chordates are characterized by the presence of notochord, solid ventral nerve cord and gill slits. Kingdom Animalia are classified into eleven animal phyla as Porifera, Cnidaria, Ctenophora, Platyhelminthes, Aschelminthes, Annelida, Arthropoda, Mollusca, Echinodermata, Hemichordata and Chordata. Chordata is the largest phylum with three sup phyla Urochordata, Cephalochordata and Vertebrata. Subphylum Vertebrata includes two divisions, Agnatha and Gnathostomata. Agnatha comprises of the class Cyclostomata. Gnathostomata includes jawed fishes (Pisces) and Tetrapoda which includes the classes amphibia, reptilia, aves and mammals.

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